SATHYABAMA

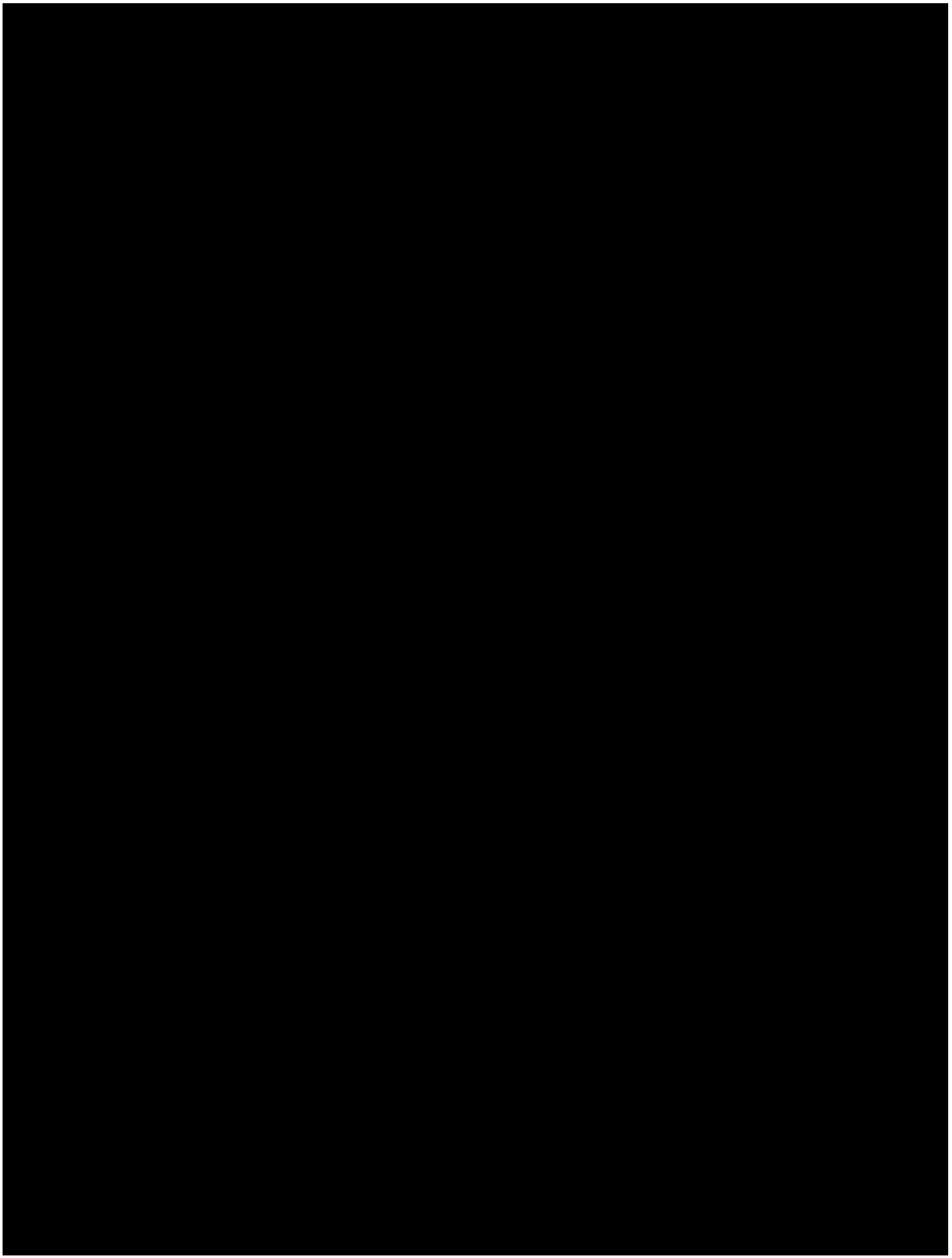
PRESENTS

RUSH HOUR

BUILD FAST // ✦ // BREAK LIMITS

PARTICIPANT GUIDELINES & HANDBOOK

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RUSH HOUR 2026

PARTICIPANT HANDBOOK

OFFICIAL HANDBOOK

Welcome to RUSH HOUR 2026. This high-intensity, 24-hour hackathon is designed to push your technical boundaries, problem-solving capabilities, and execution speed. Below are the official rules, operational structure, and expectations for all participating teams.

01 TRACK & PROBLEM STATEMENT SELECTION

- **Domain Registration:**
  Select your specific project track from the official dashboard list.
- **Problem Statement Autonomy:**
  Formulate and solve your own unique problem statement within that track.
- **Paradigm Alignment:**
  Ensure your solution strictly matches the designated paradigm (Software, Hardware, or Hybrid) of your chosen track.

02 TECHNICAL & CODE GUIDELINES

- **Development Window:**
  All core programming, engineering, and system integration must occur strictly within the designated 24-hour hackathon window.
- **Hardware Constraints:**
  Teams may bring pre-assembled physical bases, chassis, or raw housings. Sensor wiring, component integration, and functional execution must be completed entirely on-site; fully completed projects are prohibited.

- **Code Authenticity:**

  Projects must be built from scratch. While using open-source libraries, frameworks, and APIs is permitted, the core application logic must be original work.

02 TECHNICAL & CODE GUIDELINES (CONTD.)

- **Smart Tools:**
  Automated code assistants and generative development tools may be used to accelerate the workflow and augment engineering, but they must not replace original development.
- **Plagiarism:**
  Submitting pre-existing, fully formed projects or external codebases as your hackathon progress is strictly prohibited and will result in immediate disqualification.
- **Commit Transparency:**
  Teams must maintain a continuous commit history. Version control must clearly reflect active, iterative collaboration and local development throughout the event.

03 CODE SUBMISSION PROTOCOLS

- **Repository Requirement:**
  Every team must host their project source code inside a public Git repository (such as GitHub, GitLab, or Bitbucket).
- **Submission Deadline:**
  The final public Git repository link must be officially submitted through the designated hackathon platform at the closing of the final development phase.
- **Verification:**

The submitted link must contain all code, configuration files, and documentation necessary to review the project. Late submissions or broken links will not be accepted.

04 EVALUATION OVERSIGHT

- **Technical Rigor & Stability:**
  Keep your codebase functional and smooth; evaluation centers on robust logic and the absence of critical bugs or execution errors.
- **Innovation & Execution:**
  Build a novel, scalable solution showing clear engineering viability within tight timelines while addressing real-world problems and market relevance.
- **Presentation & Articulation:**
  Cleanly introduce your problem statement, outline your development methodology, and explain your backend or hardware architecture with technical precision.
- **Defensive Q&A Capacity:**
  Confidently defend technical choices against panel challenges using concrete examples, technical justification, and direct references to your repository code.

05 PRIZES & REWARDS

The total prize pool for RUSH HOUR 2026 is **₹50,000**, accompanied by career incentives:

1ST PLACE	2ND PLACE	3RD PLACE
₹25,000	**₹15,000**	**₹10,000**
Exclusive Internship	Exclusive Internship	Exclusive Internship

Special Mention: Additional internship opportunities will be awarded to standout

projects that demonstrate exceptional quality.